

6.3 How Do I Stop The Menace?

A majority of e-mail clients, both for corporate and home use, are now becoming aware of the phishing problem. Most popular free e-mail hosts also offer reasonably decent phishing protection.

E-mail providers are constantly updating their spam filters, which also eliminate phishers. These filters attempt to block phishing attempts in a variety of ways. Apart from scanning for keywords, these filters also attempt to block fraudulent or malicious attachments sent with the e-mail. By disabling the HTML viewing functionality, one can check for the authenticity of e-mails, as phishers usually send malicious mails in the form of HTML mails so as to hide their origin.

Here are simple tips to avoid being phished. Actually, if you're aware of the problem well enough, you're already a difficult phishing target!

1. Phishers usually have a sense of urgency about their e-mails. "To prevent your account from being terminated, please update your details by September 15, 2006." In general, corporations do not like to threaten their customers into action. They'd rather send an annoying sales representative to your house.

2. E-mails with embedded submission forms are something to avoid like the plague. Never fill out a



Gmail allows users to report phishing attempts